But there was no sign of either Sivarasan or Santhan. More than six hours passed and the situation remained calm. Coordinating with the rest on wireless, Kanth sent Chelladurai and Krishnamurthy disguised as Madras Water Supply servicemen to peep into the flat where Sivarasan was to come and meet Santhan. But the officers returned without any information or clue to their whereabouts. After another hour, Ragothaman went in disguise as a technician from the local telephone exchange to check the connection of the flat. But he, too, got nothing as the woman in the house told him her telephone line was working fine.

The whole day passed without any sign of Sivarasan and Santhan. Around eight at night, Verma and Raju knocked on the door of the flat and spoke to the engineer and his wife. The wife admitted that a young man, ‘Dixon’, had visited their apartment. An hour later, a Sri Lankan woman had dropped in asking for ‘Trichy Santhan’. She said she was carrying a letter for Dixon. Immediately, Dixon had sent a reply through her. A little later, a young man, Raja, came to meet Dixon. Both left together shortly thereafter.

It was clear that Dixon and Raja had come in place of Santhan and Sivarasan, respectively. But the SIT was not looking for them. The SIT only had a photograph of Sivarasan. They had no photograph of Dixon. Santhan and Sivarasan were never to visit the apartment in person. The intercepted message had actually thrown a smokescreen around the sleuths. Sivarasan had fooled the SIT once again.

Ragothaman had managed to get a photo of Dixon from a studio in Madras, where they also found a photo of Sivarasan without his false eye. Raju was the senior-most after Kaarthikeyan. He asked the members not to feel demoralized. They were dealing with super intelligence in Sivarasan and Prabhakaran. To counter that, the SIT had to up their ante, and had to be as cunning and as ruthless as them. He advised Kaarthikeyan that the team members needed rest and should take breaks in turns.